

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Okay. How old are you?

Speaker 1 [00:00:12] What's your age?

Speaker 2: [16-20].

Speaker 1: Got it. How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:26] Likely about [1-5 months]. Max.

Speaker 1 [00:00:31] And do you have children with a partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:36] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:40] And do you guys live together?

Speaker 2 [00:00:41] Separate.

Speaker 1 [00:00:48] What is your main source of income and what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:00:55] I see my main source of income and, you know, my [job]. And he works in the [job]. So he gets paid through there.

Speaker 1 [00:01:12] And how would you like me to address your partner? Boyfriend. Partner, lover.

Speaker 2 [00:01:19] [Partner].

Speaker 1 [00:01:24] And now the rest of these questions are going to be just story. And I'll just be listening. So tell me about your love story.

Speaker 2 [00:01:35] Well. We we kind of officially met my [1-4 years] in high school and his [year] of high school, too. We've known each other for a couple of [years]. But we never formally met. And he sat behind me in [class], and that just kind of kickstarted the conversation. And we've been really good friends ever since then. And I just went home from college last year for summer. And, you know, something was a little bit different. And it was just it felt like a little bit more than just friends. And then we addressed it and. Yeah, it's kind of how we both felt about it. You have any more questions?.

Speaker 1 [00:02:41] Not in that one.

Speaker 1 [00:02:44] How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:52] So far. I mean, with my age group, I'd say I'm doing pretty good. You know I have. I have already voiced my values and won when we were not together and just as friends. You know, and they kind of lined up. And so he knows and I know. You know what we both want and what we both want out of this relationship. So it was easier. You know, knowing all this information prior to actually getting together. Wonderful.

Speaker 1 [00:03:37] Can I ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:03:42] Um, [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:03:49] And how would you compare the quality of your relationship, the current one, to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:03:57] A lot better than before. You know, before there was always some kind of disconnect or miscommunication. I just kind of never got resolved.

Speaker 1 [00:04:11] And why do you think that is?

Speaker 2 [00:04:16] It had to be my fault. I know that. I mean, I'm a pretty decent person. Personality wise. I don't. And I don't connect very well just because, uh I don't know. That's just who I am. If I like you, I like you. And I have a hard time, you know? Getting that out into the air versus, you know, I know that in my head. Yeah. So.

Speaker 1 [00:04:49] You see, then they think you. Were they disconnected or is this there with your current relationship at first or maybe like somewhere throughout?

Speaker 2 [00:05:03] I don't think so. Just because we've been friends for a while. I did. Maybe in the start of the friendship. Maybe. But. All those disconnections worked themselves out before we got into dating.

Speaker 1 [00:05:26] And for you, what makes a relationship high quality or a low quality? And why do you say so.

Speaker 2 [00:05:35] I quality someone who values my time? You know I value your time. Um. You're going to put in an effort and not just like a mass effort, but like above and beyond. And not just because I want to, but because, you know, he wants to also. And, you know, he puts time in to, like, want to come and see me cause he lives in my hometown and I'm in [City] for college. But on both sides, we've made a pretty good effort in visiting each other routinely. And. You know, he does a really good job. When I'm upset or I'm. You know, just kind of sad about something he makes. Really good effort and, like, comforting me and, like, being there for me. You know, he may not always. Hit the to hit the problem spot on. But I know how hard he tries to. And I mean, really, that's all that. That's. That's a big point. I can. And low quality. You know, if I'm feeling a little upset, there's just like. I will. I will attend. Just. Oh, you'll be fine. And you know, that's not like the sense of [person] being that sincere. But more like. All right. Well, she said, I have to at least address it.

Speaker 1 [00:07:34] Like. Like a burden.

Speaker 2 [00:07:38] Yeah, sometimes. Or. And.

Speaker 1 [00:07:47] Well, what do you say your relationship was of of the highest value or the highest quality and what was it the least?

Speaker 2 [00:07:58] I definitely think the one I'm in now. Is the one of the highest quality. And the Leaf was probably my last partner before my current. You know, it was just a bunch of miscommunications, disconnects and. You know, just charity issues within himself.

Speaker 1 [00:08:32] You. Pretty much touched on this a bit. But for you, what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:08:43] And I like a partner who's going to kind of reciprocate. What I give. And with the one that I'm in currently, I feel like I've given. You know all that I can. And he's done the same thing. And I appreciate that a lot. I you know, sometimes I get a little upset and he does a really good job in either making me feel better or just kind of. Let me know. But making sure that I'm there. He's there. And either or sometimes, you know, everyone need to just kind of get through. Being sad in a solution is always the right thing. And it's nice that he does know that. And he. He did those little things without me asking, without me knowing, like. The other day I was complaining about I needed vitamins. So he took the liberty of, you know, he bought me a whole bunch of vitamins and then sent them to my place. And I didn't know. And it was just to me, that was okay. Well, here he is listening to me. He wasn't just like. He didn't just pick up the phone and let it go. He just he was you know, listening to what I was saying. And he addressed it not just, okay, she's out of vitamins, but he took action.

Speaker 1 [00:10:22] Great. Thank you. For you. What is love?

Speaker 2 [00:10:28] For me. It's when you finally feel a connection with someone that you haven't felt in the past. And it's when your mind changes. And I'm dating this person, too. I want to spend the rest of my life with this person.

Speaker 1 [00:10:54] And how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:00] I mean, I feel like it's extremely important. But it also goes hand in hand with a lot of other factors. Like love can only get you so far. You need attraction. You need forgiveness and patience and. You know, sometimes you have to disengage a little bit and that's fine. But I feel like all of those qualities are still important. And they. Love can get to. Far, but it won't get you further than that. It needs other things. It's like a triangle. It's the important piece on top, but it needs a base also.

Speaker 1 [00:11:52] I love technology.

Speaker 2 [00:11:54] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:12:00] And how does your partner how do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:10] He expresses it to me in more than just word. Like when he comes and he visits me. He makes sure he, you know, he gets here and he takes the time to give me a long hug. You know, we'll go to bed. We'll wake up. So do you want me to make you breakfast or do you want to go out? And then half the time I say, you know, let's let's make breakfast together. And then, you know, he says, yeah. And, you know, fresh. Something new, I guess. A new relationship. We both try and do a lot of like. Communication exercises. And he picked up on that pretty well. He and I have both bought like a [toy] set. And you'd be shocked at how. How important that is to kind of work together. This kind of, you know, figure that out and you weren't. You worked that out with me, even though. I might have not had the most patience or he might have not had the most patience because it's like, if I see something he doesn't, I want to see something. But then we promised each other. It'll turn out how it'll turn out. And it's fine if we have extra pieces at the end. That's fine. And. You know, it worked out pretty well. There got to be a point

where we would finish the Lego sets and we're like, You know what? We have a bag of extra pieces, but that's okay. I saw you miss them and I saw you not put them or the wrong piece. But, you know, it turned out fine. And. You know, you make effort to build a relationship with not just me, but my family. And that's a pretty, pretty important one there. That. You know, he loved my mom and my mom loves him and my brother and my step dad. He. He talks about me to his mom all the time and she'll go and she'll text me about it and kind of care.

Speaker 1 [00:14:44] Yeah. You mentioned. Like working through communication. Could you tell me more about that?

Speaker 2 [00:14:55] Yeah. So he and I. Are really similar in the way of. You know, trying to be stoic and just know I'm okay. I'm okay. And in the beginning and still now, it's hard to work through that and just kind of explain. Okay. Or work together now. You can be stoic to your friends, but you know, if there's something really bothering you. You know, we can talk about it. I'm here to talk about it with you. And he's here to talk about it with me. So we're pretty similar in. The way that we both had to, like, try and. You know, break that barrier with each other.

Speaker 1 [00:15:48] It's great. And what do you see or challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:57] Definitely the being stoic. You know that that tends to be an issue sometimes where if he or she or they have a bad day or something. You know, the tone or the attitude or demeanor will change. And then, you know, one of us is like, well, what's wrong? What happened? Are you okay? And then it's like, no, I'm fine.

Speaker 1 [00:16:35] Do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:16:39] No.

Speaker 1 [00:16:48] And what are other ways that you maintain your relationship? You did mention a couple.

Speaker 2 [00:16:58] We both make an effort every [1-5] weeks. If he comes here and then [1-5] weeks later, I will go home. So we're both driving to each other like [1-5] a month, but we get to see each other every [1-5] weeks and. Oh, it's like a medium or a long distance relationship. Is that that's where it kind of gets a little sticky, is when it's like, Oh, well, I want to hang out with my friends this weekend. But he's definitely. You know, put it up there to be like, No, Yeah. If my friends wanted to hang out, they would have said something last week, you know? Mhm. And so it, it's just like the commitment. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:18:00] What do you say? The relationship is good for you.

Speaker 2 [00:18:04] Yeah, I do. And why? I've been a relatively no risk person for as long as I can remember. I can't sleep. I can't, you know, kind of clear my head and relax. And that's been a pretty. Pretty significant thing with me is I can't really calm down. I can't sleep. I still a little bit nervous on guard, whatever. But. You know, he when he comes around and he tries to calm me down, he puts it in different perspective. And so I can actually, like, calm down.

Speaker 1 [00:19:03] You provide me with an example that you remember?

Speaker 2 [00:19:11] See. Yeah, I can. Before I moved to school, I was talking to my [parent]. And that's the. That's a pretty rough relationship. No, not the easiest. And. And I was asking about his [Bill] because he served in the military and he received the [Bill]. And because we have such a bad relationship with what I was a really hard conversation for me to walk into. And. You know, afterwards I found out that he said yes and he would give that to me. And I felt really good. And then the morning after, my mom walks in my room and she's like, hey, I called the [financial benefits]. this morning and you can't there's no way you can get the bill. And essentially that would pay for my college. So I wouldn't have to deal with any debt. And I was too. That kind of destroyed my mind from the time I was. I was really bummed out. I was so stressed to walk into the conversation in the first place and I was relieved. When he said yes. And, you know, come to find out, I did all of that for nothing. I can't even get it in the first place. I was just, you know, I was just torn. I was really, really. You know, just. Not doing well with that. And. He was supposed to come over that day. So then he still did. And then I kind of told him about what was going on and he was like, okay, well, let's let's go do something. And I was like, all right. And I'm still just kind of mopey about everything. And he got me my favorite ice cream and he took me on a drive and listened to music that we both like. And then when we got home, like, we watched movies and stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:21:49] And the person that drove your argument, you said it was your [parent], right?

Speaker 2 [00:21:54] No, it was my planning. Okay. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:22:04] Would you say that the relationship changed to?

Speaker 2 [00:22:09] It changed me. I think so.

Speaker 1 [00:22:13] In what way?

Speaker 2 [00:22:16] I think it changed me in a better way. I feel like I'm a little more calm than I have been the last couple of years. I feel like I just kind of have someone to always talk to, you know, maybe not clear my mind, but I get some of the thoughts out of it. And, you know, I know I have someone to fall back on and someone who loves me and. Like I did. I had someone who's there for me verses before I did it. Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:22:54] And what about your partner that they changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:00] I feel like he did, too. He's expressed, you know, he's. He's trying to be a little bit more vulnerable. And, you know, he's a lot more vulnerable than he used to be and he feels like that's a good thing. And he can. He can just kind of be happy. And he can. Sit down and relax. Same thing I said. We just have someone to fall back on, and that's a little bit of comfort.

Speaker 1 [00:23:49] Do you feel safe in the relationship? And why do you see so.

Speaker 2 [00:23:53] Absolutely. And because. He he would never hurt anything, ever. And that absolutely includes me. He has a great relationship with his family, and has a great relationship with me. A great relationship with my family. And. He never says anything that would potentially hurt my feelings. He would never do anything. You know,

every time I see him, I don't get a little nervous. I feel a lot more safe than I would. You know, walking around by myself or, you know, even my own [parent]. Three.

Speaker 1 [00:25:01] All right. So this is a Likert scale from one.

Speaker 2 [00:25:06] Not at all.

Speaker 1 [00:25:07] [True/false] to nine. Completely [true/false]. If I were to ask, my partner usually really listens to me. What would you answer?

Speaker 2 [00:25:15] [5-10] He just kind of remembers things that I may not remember saying. Tell. Remind me. Oh, well, I did this because you said that or you mentioned Ms.. And I was like, oh, well, I didn't. I didn't really remember saying that or I didn't really think you were paying attention. And he always is kind of, you know, like the vitamin example. Great.

Speaker 1 [00:26:03] And the same with the [Basketball team]. Go from [1-9].

Speaker 2 [00:26:09] Completely true.

Speaker 1 [00:26:12] What about if I were to ask? My partner usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:26:20] [5-10].

Speaker 1 [00:26:23] And for the next one. All right. So going back to the first question about. My partner usually really listens to me. Why was he a [5-10] and why not a nine or why not a seven?

Speaker 2 [00:26:50] I'm not a nine because I don't think anyone can truly. You know, listen to someone all the time. Like if he has something going on at the same time, it might be a little bit hard for him to think about my needs and also his own. And that, you know, is completely fine and not a cousin because even though he. Might not intentionally. Think about what I'm saying. I know he's trying.

Speaker 1 [00:27:34] And back to my partner usually is responsive to my needs. why [5-10] and not an eight.

Speaker 2 [00:27:48] Because. Regardless of how I'm feeling, if I'm feeling sick, if I'm feeling happy, if I'm feeling sad or angry, be. He always adjusts or adapts or. You know, the last time I was a little bit sad or stressed about school. He was like, okay, I'm going to come and see you tomorrow. Which wasn't part of the plan, the routine, but. He was like, you know, it's just about school. I'm going to come and see you tomorrow. Which was. It felt really nice.

Speaker 1 [00:28:47] Yeah. I hope you don't mind if I ask. And feel free to say if you think it's too sensitive for you to share. But I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. Are you okay with proceeding?

Speaker 2 [00:29:02] Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:29:04] These days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:29:09] Every two weeks when we see each other.

Speaker 1 [00:29:18] All right. And how satisfied are you with your sex life and what do you see? So.

Speaker 2 [00:29:25] Completely satisfied. He listens to me. You know, the do's and don'ts, the wants and could want or don't want. He. Completely, you know, just very, very caring and very. You know, kind of romantic. But also he knows when to not be romantic. Be.

Speaker 1 [00:29:59] Right. Moving on. In general, how satisfied are you with your relationship? Completely dissatisfied. Very dissatisfied. Somewhat dissatisfied. Unsure or neutral. Somewhat satisfied. Very satisfied. Or completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:30:17] Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:30:48] Why? Completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:30:52] I feel like all of my wants and needs. Are actively being fulfilled. You can't completely fulfill them already because there's always going to be more wants and needs. But. He tries his best to actively fulfill, you know, personal, physical, emotional. Wants and needs that I may have.

Speaker 1 [00:31:26] And that the relationship fulfilling your expectations.

Speaker 2 [00:31:31] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:31:46] All right. So we're close to wrapping up. And I would just like to summarize what we have talked about in the past hour. So.

Speaker 2 [00:31:57] When we scroll up.

Speaker 1 [00:32:00] So you guys have been together for [1-5] months. You guys met in your [year] of school and on each other for a couple of years after that. And you guys met while being in class and. He sat behind you, been good friends, and then decided that you guys felt more than friends. So that's when you started. In terms of quality of relationship. You guys have expressed your values and know what you both want out of the relationship and you have [1-5] romantic partners in the past. But with this current relationship, there's a lot more connection. And you did mention that you're a decent person, but because of the friendship, you feel that a kind of made a base or foundation for the connection and then. You. You said that your your relationship is of high value because both of you guys value your time. And put in a lot of effort, not just because you said it's like a necessity, but moral because you want.

Speaker 2 [00:33:28] To say that.

Speaker 1 [00:33:31] You mentioned that in your past relationships there that was not available, that there was low quality and. Yeah. Your current relationship is of high quality. All efforts In terms of what's most important, you mentioned that all the efforts are reciprocated and communication is present, great communication as well, and attention to detail in terms of your partner. Fulfilling your needs you or you feel like your listen to a law.

Speaker 2 [00:34:14] And.

Speaker 1 [00:34:15] Your needs are addressed. And you said in terms of what is love, you feel connection. It something is love. If you feel connection with someone that you haven't felt before. And. Love in a relationship is extremely important because you could only go so far. So forgiveness, attraction, patience and understanding. And you gave the triangle analogy, and you also mentioned that your partner has a great relationship with their family.

Speaker 2 [00:34:55] And.

Speaker 1 [00:34:58] Actively working on communication. And how do you know that your partner loves use? By expressing it more than just words. So by actions. And that challenge would be being stoic. And there are no fights. You make an effort to see each other twice or every [1-5] weeks and. He, your partner, your boyfriend tries to comfort you whenever. Or like towards the beginning of the relationship with which in turn has made you a calmer person. So that's the way that the relationship has changed you. And why it's good for you. And you believe your partner has changed and has been slowly becoming more vulnerable.

Speaker 2 [00:36:03] You.

Speaker 1 [00:36:05] You feel safe in the relationship? And. You listed your answers for, like this girl. From 1 to 9, your partner usually really listens. See? You said a. And that is because there's always room for improvement and a nine for your partner is usually responsive to your needs because of the effort. And then you guys have sex every [1-5] weeks. When you see each other and you feel satisfied with it because there he listens to your wants and needs and knows and yess and is very caring and romantic. And overall, you're completely satisfied in your relationship. Right. With all of that said, is there anything you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:37:15] Um, no, I don't think so.

Speaker 1 [00:37:19] Right. So thank you so much. And yeah, that's pretty much it. And before we end, I want to talk to you about how we handle the data as a research project. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible. So we. And I wanted to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with. And you did. I have here the consent form. You check the full transcript. So except sensitive detail can be shared. Is that correct?

Speaker 2 [00:37:54] Yeah. And.

Speaker 1 [00:38:00] Yeah. So thank you so much again for participating in this study. And I would like for you to know that this is also being done in the [country], [country], [country], France and the [country]. So this is the [country] segment. And for this study to be successful. There is also one more thing I would like to ask you if that's okay for you. Can you recommend to close people in your life as a nominator? We would like we would ask them for additional couples that might be interested in the study. And. See, But we'll be asking them for couples that you don't know or interact with. This way we can get a diverse network that we can get. Is that okay with you?

Speaker 2 [00:38:53] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:38:54] All right. And just feel free to send that information over by email. And we'll be contacting them either today or tomorrow. And we'll also be grateful if you can give them like a heads up so they don't block us when we contact them. But yeah, so that's pretty much it. And thank you so much for everything.

Speaker 2 [00:39:19] Yeah, I had one question. Yes. So I did see in the string of emails that my partner will also be interviewed. Yes. And when I can see like scheduling for that.

Speaker 1 [00:39:34] Yeah. So you can just give me do you happen to know his schedule or when he's available?

Speaker 2 [00:39:39] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:39:40] Okay. Yeah. So I could just write it down and then send over an invite.

Speaker 2 [00:39:45] Okay, so. Today. Anything after [time].. Usually, usually [day]. But next [day]if you have like a [time].. That would be. That would work out really good. The. That would be [date].

Speaker 1 [00:40:22] All right? Yep. [time]. is open.

Speaker 2 [00:40:27] Tonight? Yes. All right. Let me let him know that.

Speaker 1 [00:40:37] Yeah. And if you could also provide me with their email so I could send over the invite.

Speaker 2 [00:40:43] Yes, I can. Okay. Email. Yes. So [email].

Speaker 1 [00:40:55] [email]

Speaker 2 [00:40:58] [email]

Speaker 1 [00:41:07] Okay. And I'll just type it down just to double check.

Speaker 2 [00:41:12] Make sure.

Speaker 1 [00:41:24] Is that right?

Speaker 2 [00:41:27] [email]

Speaker 1 [00:41:31] Got it. All right. So, yeah, thank you so much. And I'll send over the invite. And.

Speaker 2 [00:41:37] Yeah. All right. Thank you so much.

Speaker 1 [00:41:41] Yeah. Thank you so much. All right. Have a good day.

Speaker 2 [00:41:44] You too. Bye bye. Bye.